



The Great American 4th of July

Trivia & Activity Pack — 100 Questions, 5 Games, Answer Keys

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The Great American Trivia Game

100 questions • 9 rounds • answer key with a "retell-it" fact under every answer (2026 America-250 edition: Round 7 — "The Fourth of July Itself" — plus NEW Round 8 — "The Fight for Freedom" — and Round 9 — "Monuments, Mottoes & American Icons" — bring the pack to 100.)

Print this and the answer key (04-answer-keys.md). Read a question aloud; players write or call out their answer. One point each. Every answer includes a true fact to retell at the table.

ROUND 1 — The Road to 1776

1. In what year did the First Continental Congress first meet?
 2. The 1773 protest in which colonists dumped tea into a harbor is known as the _____.
 3. In which city did the Second Continental Congress meet and adopt the Declaration of Independence?
 4. "The shot heard round the world" refers to the opening battles of the Revolution at Lexington and _____.
 5. Who was the commander-in-chief of the Continental Army?
 6. What 1775 midnight ride warned that British troops were marching? (Name the most famous rider.)
 7. The famous pamphlet "Common Sense," which urged independence, was written by whom?
 8. True or False: The Boston Massacre happened *after* the Declaration of Independence.
 9. What was the name of the 1765 tax on paper goods that outraged the colonies?
 10. The rallying cry against taxation without representation was "No taxation without _____."
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ROUND 2 — The Declaration & the Signers

1. On what exact date is Independence Day celebrated?
2. Who was the principal author of the Declaration of Independence?
3. Which future president was on the five-member committee to draft the Declaration and later helped edit it, alongside Jefferson and Adams?
4. Whose signature on the Declaration is the largest and most famous?
5. How many men signed the Declaration of Independence (the commonly cited number)?
6. The Declaration says all men are endowed with three unalienable rights: Life, Liberty, and the pursuit of _____.
7. True or False: The Declaration was fully signed by everyone on July 4, 1776.
8. On what date did the Continental Congress actually *vote* to approve independence (two days before the 4th)?
9. Which elder statesman and inventor, then the oldest delegate, signed the Declaration at age 70?
10. The Declaration lists grievances against which British king?

ROUND 3 — Old Glory & Our Symbols

1. How many stars are on the current United States flag?
2. How many stripes are on the flag, and what do they represent?
3. What do the 50 stars on the flag represent?
4. The national anthem, "The Star-Spangled Banner," was written during the bombardment of which fort?
5. Who wrote the words to "The Star-Spangled Banner"?
6. What is the nickname of the large flag associated with the national anthem, now at the Smithsonian?
7. What bird is the national bird and emblem of the United States?

8. The Liberty Bell is located in which city?
 9. What Latin phrase, meaning "Out of many, one," appears on the Great Seal?
 10. In what year were the two newest states, Alaska and Hawaii, admitted, bringing the flag to 50 stars?
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ROUND 4 — Presidents & Founders

1. Who was the first President of the United States?
 2. Who was the third President and principal author of the Declaration?
 3. Which two Founding Fathers and presidents both died on July 4, 1826 — the 50th anniversary of independence?
 4. Which president is on the one-dollar bill?
 5. Whose face is on the U.S. five-dollar bill?
 6. Which Founding Father is famous for the kite-and-key lightning experiment and for never being president?
 7. Which president delivered the Gettysburg Address?
 8. How many presidents have there been to serve (by the number commonly used for the office, as of 2026)? (Accept 46 or 47 — see answer key.)
 9. Which president was in office during the American Bicentennial in 1976?
 10. True or False: George Washington's face appears on Mount Rushmore.
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ROUND 5 — The 50 States

1. Which state was the first to ratify the Constitution (the "First State")?
2. What is the largest U.S. state by land area?
3. What is the smallest U.S. state by area?
4. Which 13 stripes on the flag represent the original 13 what?
5. Which state is known as the "Lone Star State"?

6. Philadelphia, where independence was declared, is in which state?
 7. Which state was the 50th to join the Union?
 8. Which original colony is named after a Latin word meaning "wooded" or forested land? (Hint: it borders the Atlantic in the mid-Atlantic region.)
 9. What is the capital of the United States?
 10. Which state's nickname is the "Bay State," home to Boston and the early Revolution?
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ROUND 6 — America 250: The Semiquincentennial

1. What anniversary of American independence does the nation mark on July 4, 2026?
 2. What single word means a "250th anniversary"?
 3. In what year was the Declaration of Independence adopted?
 4. Do the math: 1776 plus 250 equals what year?
 5. The 200th anniversary of independence, celebrated in 1976, is called the _____.
 6. True or False: The U.S. Mint has issued special coin designs to mark the 250th anniversary.
 7. What color combination — three colors — defines American patriotic celebration?
 8. The 250th anniversary is sometimes abbreviated with the year range "1776 to _____."
 9. On what day of the week does July 4 fall in 2026? (Hint: it's a full holiday weekend.)
 10. Fill in the toast: "Happy Birthday, America — 250 years of _____." (Any patriotic word accepted; see answer key for the intended one.)
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ROUND 7 — The Fourth of July Itself (traditions, firsts & fun)

1. Which town holds America's oldest *continuous* Fourth of July celebration, dating all the way back to 1785?
2. About how many hot dogs do Americans eat on the Fourth of July each year, by a widely cited industry estimate?
3. What famous eating contest is held every Fourth of July at Coney Island in Brooklyn, New York?
4. Which U.S. president was *born* on the Fourth of July (in 1872)?
5. In what year was the first organized Fourth of July celebration held, with fireworks in Philadelphia?
6. In a July 1776 letter, which Founding Father predicted the day would be marked with "illuminations" (fireworks), parades, and bonfires?
7. In what year did Congress first make Independence Day a federal holiday?
8. Most of the fireworks set off in America each Fourth are imported from which country?
9. TRUE or LEGEND — Betsy Ross sewed the very first American flag.
10. Who is traditionally said to be the real-life namesake of "Uncle Sam" — a meatpacker from Troy, New York?
11. On the stone tablet cradled in the arm of the Statue of Liberty, what date is carved in Roman numerals?
12. Each Fourth of July, the Liberty Bell is symbolically tapped how many times — one for each original colony?
13. What chemical element gives fireworks their bright RED color?
14. What element is used to make GREEN fireworks?
15. In what year did "The Star-Spangled Banner" officially become the national anthem of the United States?
16. Who wrote the words to the patriotic hymn "America the Beautiful" in 1893?

17. "Yankee Doodle" started out as a song that did WHAT to the American colonists — before they proudly claimed it as their own?
 18. Which city hosts the Macy's fireworks show, one of the largest Independence Day displays in the country?
 19. In 1958, a 17-year-old student named Robert Heft designed which version of the American flag as a high-school project?
 20. On what date was the Declaration of Independence first read aloud to the public in Philadelphia?
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ROUND 8 — The Fight for Freedom: Battles & Heroes of the Revolution

1. At which 1781 Virginia siege did British General Cornwallis surrender, effectively ending major fighting in the Revolution?
2. What 1783 treaty officially ended the Revolutionary War and recognized American independence?
3. At which brutal winter encampment of 1777-78 did Washington's army endure the cold and drill into a professional force?
4. Which French nobleman — just 19 years old when he arrived in 1777 — became a major general in the Continental Army and one of Washington's closest allies?
5. Which 1777 American victory in upstate New York convinced France to enter the war on America's side?
6. On the icy night of December 25-26, 1776, Washington crossed which river to surprise the enemy at Trenton?
7. Which American naval captain, his ship shattered and sinking, is famed for answering a surrender demand with "I have not yet begun to fight"?
8. Which American general turned traitor and plotted to hand the fort at West Point to the British?

9. Which 21-year-old schoolteacher-turned-spy is remembered for the words "I only regret that I have but one life to lose for my country"?
 10. TRUE or FALSE — A Massachusetts woman named Deborah Sampson disguised herself as a man and served in the Continental Army.
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ROUND 9 — Monuments, Mottoes & American Icons

1. The Statue of Liberty was a gift to the United States from which country?
 2. Mount Rushmore stands in the Black Hills of which state?
 3. Who thundered "Give me liberty, or give me death!" in a 1775 speech in Virginia?
 4. What 555-foot marble obelisk, completed in 1884 to honor the first president, was briefly the tallest structure in the world?
 5. In what year was the Pledge of Allegiance written — 1792, 1892, or 1932?
 6. On the Great Seal, the eagle grips an olive branch in one talon — how many arrows does it hold in the other?
 7. During which war did British troops burn the White House (in 1814)?
 8. Which patriotic song did Irving Berlin write — the one Kate Smith made famous in her 1938 radio broadcast?
 9. Independence Hall and the Statue of Liberty both carry what rare international honor?
 10. TRUE or LEGEND — Benjamin Franklin officially proposed the turkey as America's national bird.
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Answer key with retell-it facts: see 04-answer-keys.md

America-250 Cookout Bundle — 5

Party Activities

Print and hand out. All answers are in the ANSWER SECTION at the bottom.

Activity 1 — Star-Spangled Banner Fill-in-the-Blank

Fill in the missing words of the first verse of the national anthem. (Crowd favorite — read it aloud together at the end.)

> Oh, say can you (1)_____, by the dawn's early (2)_____, > What so proudly we hailed at the twilight's last (3)_____? > Whose broad stripes and bright (4)_____, through the perilous fight, > O'er the ramparts we watched, were so gallantly (5)_____? > And the rockets' red (6)_____, the bombs bursting in (7)_____, > Gave proof through the night that our (8)_____ was still there. > Oh, say does that star-spangled (9)_____ yet wave, > O'er the land of the (10)_____ and the home of the (11)_____?

Activity 2 — Name That Founding Year (State Matching)

Match each state to the year it entered the Union. Draw a line.

State		Year it entered the Union
A. Delaware		1. 1959
B. Texas		2. 1788
C. California		3. 1787
D. Hawaii		4. 1850
E. Pennsylvania		5. 1845

Activity 3 — Red, White & Blue Scavenger Hunt

First to check off all 10 wins. Look around the cookout!

- [] Something with all three flag colors
- [] An actual American flag (any size)
- [] Something star-shaped
- [] A red food
- [] A blue food or drink
- [] Something "Made in USA"
- [] A hat or shirt with a flag on it
- [] Fireworks or a sparkler (unlit!)
- [] A coin with a president on it
- [] Someone named after a president or Founding Father

Activity 4 — Patriotic Word Scramble

Unscramble these 12 patriotic words.

1. GALF → _____
2. BLIYERT → _____
3. AGELE → _____
4. EEDFROM → _____
5. NOIUN → _____
6. OATTIPR → _____
7. ACIREMA → _____
8. RSTAS → _____
9. DNEPEDENNECI → _____
10. GNIHSAWTON → _____

11. WOFIRESRK → _____

12. NADTIRECOAL → _____

Activity 5 — "How Well Do You Know the 4th?"

True/False Lightning Round

1. Independence Day is on July 4th. **T / F**
 2. Most delegates actually signed the Declaration in August, not on July 4th. **T / F**
 3. The flag has 52 stars. **T / F**
 4. John Adams and Thomas Jefferson both died on July 4, 1826. **T / F**
 5. America turns 250 years old in 2026. **T / F**
 6. The bald eagle is our national bird. **T / F**
 7. The Liberty Bell is in New York City. **T / F**
 8. "The Star-Spangled Banner" was written at Fort McHenry. **T / F**
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ANSWER SECTION

Activity 1 — Anthem: (1) see, (2) light, (3) gleaming, (4) stars, (5) streaming, (6) glare, (7) air, (8) flag, (9) banner, (10) free, (11) brave.

Activity 2 — State years: A-3 (Delaware, 1787) · B-5 (Texas, 1845) · C-4 (California, 1850) · D-1 (Hawaii, 1959) · E-2 (Pennsylvania, 1788).

Activity 3 — Scavenger hunt: self-checked, no answer key.

Activity 4 — Word scramble:

1. GALF = **FLAG**
2. BLIYERT = **LIBERTY**
3. AGELE = **EAGLE**
4. EEDFROM = **FREEDOM**

- 5. NOIUN = **UNION**
- 6. OATTIPR = **PATRIOT**
- 7. ACIREMA = **AMERICA**
- 8. RSTAS = **STARS**
- 9. DNEPEDENNECI = **INDEPENDENCE**
- 10. GNIHSAWTON = **WASHINGTON**
- 11. WOFIRESRK = **FIREWORKS**
- 12. NADTIRECOAL = **DECLARATION**

Activity 5 — True/False: 1-T, 2-T, 3-F (50 stars), 4-T, 5-T, 6-T, 7-F (Philadelphia), 8-T.

The 1776 -> 2026 Timeline Placemat

Print one per place setting. Read the opening line aloud to start the cookout. Facts verified — see [.sources.md](#).

> **America turns 250.** From a tax revolt to a nation of 50 states, here is the road — 250 years in > ten milestones. Happy Birthday, America.

The Road to 250 — Ten Milestones

1774 — The Colonies Unite. The First Continental Congress meets in Philadelphia to answer British punishment of Massachusetts.

1775 — The War Begins. The battles of Lexington and Concord open the Revolution; George Washington is named commander-in-chief of the Continental Army.

1776 — Independence Declared. On July 2 the Continental Congress votes for independence; on July 4 it adopts the Declaration of Independence, principally authored by Thomas Jefferson.

1783 — The War Won. The Treaty of Paris ends the Revolutionary War and Britain recognizes American independence.

1787-1788 — A Constitution. The Constitution is written in 1787; Delaware ratifies first, becoming "The First State."

1789 — The First President. George Washington takes office as the first President of the United States.

1814 — The Anthem is Born. Francis Scott Key, watching the flag survive the bombardment of Fort McHenry, writes the words to "The Star-Spangled Banner."

1826 — A Remarkable Fourth. On July 4, exactly 50 years after independence, both John Adams and Thomas Jefferson die on the same day.

1959-1960 — Fifty Stars. Alaska and Hawaii become the 49th and 50th states; the 50-star flag we know today becomes official on July 4, 1960.

2026 — America 250. The nation marks the semiquincentennial — 250 years of American independence on July 4, 2026.

Turn me over and quiz the table: which milestone is your favorite? What will America look like at its 300th, in 2076?

Host & Answer Keys

Everything the emcee needs: full answer key with retell-it facts, scoring sheet, and a 20-minute run-of-show. Fact-checked — see [.sources.md](#).

COOKOUT EMCEE RUN-OF-SHOW (20 minutes)

1. **(2 min) Welcome & the toast.** Read the timeline placemat's opening line aloud, then:

"This year isn't just the Fourth — it's America's 250th birthday. Let's play."

2. **(12 min) Trivia.** Pick any 6 of the 9 rounds for a 20-minute party (or run all 9 for a

~30-minute championship). Read each question; players write answers on the scoring sheet (or shout for a fast game). Read the answer AND the retell-it fact — that's the part people remember.

3. **(4 min) One activity.** Pick from 02-activities.md — the Star-Spangled Banner fill-in-the-blank

is the crowd favorite and works for all ages.

4. **(2 min) Score & the closing toast.** Tally points, crown "Most Patriotic," and close with:

"Happy Birthday, America — 250 years of freedom."

TRIVIA ANSWER KEY (with retell-it facts)

Round 1 — The Road to 1776

1. **1774.** The First Continental Congress met in Philadelphia in the fall of 1774 to respond to

British punishments of Massachusetts.

2. **Boston Tea Party.** On December 16, 1773, colonists dumped 342 chests of British tea into Boston Harbor to protest taxation.
3. **Philadelphia.** The Second Continental Congress met in Philadelphia beginning in 1775 and adopted the Declaration there in 1776.
4. **Concord.** The battles of Lexington and Concord on April 19, 1775, began the Revolutionary War.
5. **George Washington.** He was appointed commander-in-chief of the Continental Army in June 1775.
6. **Paul Revere.** His April 18-19, 1775 ride helped warn that British troops were on the move
(William Dawes and Samuel Prescott rode too — accept those as bonus).
7. **Thomas Paine.** His pamphlet "Common Sense" (January 1776) sold widely and swayed public opinion toward independence.
8. **False.** The Boston Massacre was March 5, 1770 — *before* the 1776 Declaration.
9. **The Stamp Act (1765).** It taxed printed materials and helped ignite colonial resistance.
10. **Representation.** "No taxation without representation" captured the colonists' core grievance.

Round 2 — The Declaration & the Signers

1. **July 4th.** Independence Day marks the adoption of the Declaration of Independence.
2. **Thomas Jefferson.** He was the principal author of the Declaration's draft in June 1776.
3. **John Adams** (also **Benjamin Franklin**). Both served on the five-man drafting committee with

Jefferson; Adams became the 2nd president and Franklin never did. (Accept either.)

4. **John Hancock.** As president of Congress, his large, bold signature became legendary.
5. **56.** Fifty-six delegates are recognized as signers of the Declaration.
6. **Happiness.** "Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness."
7. **False.** Independence was voted July 2 and the text adopted July 4, but most delegates signed
the engrossed copy on **August 2, 1776**, and some later.
8. **July 2, 1776.** Congress voted to approve the resolution of independence on July 2; John Adams
thought *that* would be the celebrated date.
9. **Benjamin Franklin.** At 70, he was the oldest signer of the Declaration.
10. **King George III.** The Declaration's grievances are addressed against George III of Britain.

Round 3 — Old Glory & Our Symbols

1. **50 stars.** One for each state.
2. **13 stripes — the 13 original colonies.** Seven red and six white stripes.
3. **The 50 states.** Each star represents a state in the Union.
4. **Fort McHenry.** The 1814 British bombardment of Fort McHenry in Baltimore inspired the anthem.
5. **Francis Scott Key.** He wrote the poem that became "The Star-Spangled Banner" in September 1814.
6. **The Star-Spangled Banner (flag).** The garrison flag that flew over Fort McHenry is preserved
at the Smithsonian's National Museum of American History.
7. **The bald eagle.** It has been the national emblem since 1782 and was designated the national

bird by law in 2024.

8. **Philadelphia.** The Liberty Bell is displayed near Independence Hall.
9. **E Pluribus Unum.** "Out of many, one" — a traditional motto on the Great Seal.
10. **1959.** Alaska (Jan 3, 1959) and Hawaii (Aug 21, 1959) became the 49th and 50th states; the 50-star flag became official July 4, 1960.

Round 4 — Presidents & Founders

1. **George Washington.** He took office in 1789 as the first president.
2. **Thomas Jefferson.** The 3rd president and principal author of the Declaration.
3. **John Adams and Thomas Jefferson.** Both died on July 4, 1826 — the 50th anniversary of independence. (James Monroe, the 5th president, also died on a July 4, in 1831 — bonus fact.)
4. **George Washington.** He appears on the \$1 bill.
5. **Abraham Lincoln.** The 16th president is on the \$5 bill.
6. **Benjamin Franklin.** Inventor, diplomat, and signer — he was never president.
7. **Abraham Lincoln.** He delivered the Gettysburg Address in November 1863.
8. **Accept 46 or 47.** Historically the office is counted by administrations: Donald Trump is numbered the 45th and the 47th president because Grover Cleveland's two non-consecutive terms are counted separately — so there have been **45 individuals** but the current president is called the **47th**. (This is a great "well, actually" fact to retell.)
9. **Gerald Ford.** He was president during the 1976 Bicentennial.

10. **True.** Washington is one of the four faces carved on Mount Rushmore (with Jefferson, Lincoln, and Theodore Roosevelt).

Round 5 — The 50 States

1. **Delaware.** It ratified the Constitution first, on December 7, 1787 — "The First State."
2. **Alaska.** It is the largest U.S. state by land area.
3. **Rhode Island.** It is the smallest U.S. state by total area.
4. **Colonies.** The 13 stripes stand for the 13 original colonies.
5. **Texas.** The "Lone Star State."
6. **Pennsylvania.** Philadelphia is in Pennsylvania.
7. **Hawaii.** It became the 50th state on August 21, 1959.
8. **Pennsylvania.** "Pennsylvania" combines the Penn family name with the Latin *sylvania*, meaning "woodland" — it means "Penn's Woods." (Accept Pennsylvania.)
9. **Washington, D.C.** The nation's capital.
10. **Massachusetts.** The "Bay State," home to Boston, Lexington, and Concord.

Round 6 — America 250: The Semiquincentennial

1. **The 250th anniversary.** July 4, 2026 marks 250 years of American independence.
2. **Semiquincentennial** (also called the *sestercentennial* or *bicenquingagenary*). "Semiquincentennial" is the term the U.S. commission uses.
3. **1776.** The Declaration was adopted July 4, 1776.
4. **2026.** $1776 + 250 = 2026$.
5. **Bicentennial.** The 200th anniversary was celebrated in 1976.

6. **True.** The U.S. Mint has issued semiquincentennial (250th-anniversary) coin designs for 2026.
7. **Red, white, and blue.** The colors of the flag and of American celebration.
8. **2026.** "1776 to 2026" spans the 250 years.
9. **Saturday.** July 4, 2026 falls on a Saturday.
10. **Freedom** (intended answer; accept any patriotic word — liberty, independence, etc.).

Round 7 — The Fourth of July Itself

1. **Bristol, Rhode Island.** It has celebrated the Fourth every year since 1785 — the oldest continuous Independence Day celebration in the U.S. It began when Rev. Henry Wight, a Revolutionary War veteran, led the town's first Patriotic Exercises, and grew into the country's oldest Fourth of July parade.
2. **About 150 million.** The National Hot Dog and Sausage Council estimates Americans eat roughly 150 million hot dogs on July 4th alone.
3. **Nathan's Famous Hot Dog Eating Contest.** Held at Coney Island every Fourth of July since the early 1900s (by tradition), it's now a nationally televised July-4 spectacle.
4. **Calvin Coolidge.** The 30th president is the only U.S. president born on the Fourth of July — July 4, 1872. (James Monroe, John Adams, and Thomas Jefferson all *died* on a Fourth.)
5. **1777.** The first organized Fourth of July celebration was held in Philadelphia in 1777, with a "grand exhibition of fireworks," ships firing 13-gun salutes, and the city illuminated.

6. **John Adams.** In a July 3, 1776 letter to his wife Abigail, Adams predicted the day would be solemnized "with Pomp and Parade... Bonfires and Illuminations" — he just thought it'd be July 2nd.
7. **1870.** Congress made Independence Day a federal holiday in 1870 (unpaid for federal workers);
it became a *paid* federal holiday in 1938.
8. **China.** The large majority of fireworks used in the U.S. are imported, most of them from China.
9. **LEGEND.** The beloved story that Betsy Ross sewed the first flag is undocumented — it was popularized
by her grandson nearly a century later, with no contemporary proof. (A great story; just not verified.)
10. **Samuel Wilson.** A meatpacker from Troy, New York who supplied barrels stamped "U.S." during the War
of 1812 is the traditional namesake of "Uncle Sam"; Congress recognized him as the namesake in 1961.
11. **July 4, 1776** — carved as "JULY IV MDCCLXXVI" on the tablet the Statue of Liberty holds in her left arm.
12. **13 times.** Descendants of the signers symbolically tap the Liberty Bell 13 times each Fourth of July,
once for each of the 13 original colonies. (The bell is tapped, not rung — it's cracked.)
13. **Strontium.** Strontium salts burn bright red in fireworks.
14. **Barium.** Barium compounds produce green. (Copper makes blue; sodium, yellow.)
15. **1931.** "The Star-Spangled Banner" was made the official national anthem by Congress on March 3, 1931 —
over a century after Francis Scott Key wrote the words in 1814.

16. **Katharine Lee Bates.** She wrote "America the Beautiful" in 1893, inspired by the view from Pikes Peak, Colorado.
17. **Mocked / ridiculed them.** British troops sang "Yankee Doodle" to make fun of the "unsophisticated" colonials — who then embraced it as their own marching song.
18. **New York City.** The Macy's 4th of July Fireworks is one of the largest displays in the United States.
19. **The 50-star flag.** Robert G. Heft designed the current 50-star flag as a high-school project in 1958 (anticipating Alaska and Hawaii); it became official in 1960. (He reportedly first got a B- on it.)
20. **July 8, 1776.** The Declaration was first read aloud to the public on July 8, 1776, in the yard of the Pennsylvania State House (Independence Hall) in Philadelphia.

Round 8 — The Fight for Freedom: Battles & Heroes of the Revolution

1. **Yorktown.** Cornwallis surrendered at Yorktown, Virginia on October 19, 1781, to a combined American and French force — the last major battle of the Revolution.
2. **The Treaty of Paris.** Signed September 3, 1783, it officially ended the war and recognized the United States as an independent nation.
3. **Valley Forge.** Through the winter of 1777-78, Washington's army endured hunger and cold there — and Baron von Steuben drilled it into a disciplined professional force.
4. **The Marquis de Lafayette.** The 19-year-old French nobleman crossed the Atlantic in 1777, spent

his own fortune on the American cause, and became like a son to Washington.
(Fifty years later a grateful America invited him back — he toured all 24 states.)

5. **Saratoga.** The American victory at Saratoga, New York (October 1777) convinced France to join
the war as an American ally in 1778 — the turning point of the Revolution.
6. **The Delaware River.** Washington's Christmas-night 1776 crossing led to the surprise victory
at Trenton the next morning — a desperately needed win that saved the Revolution's morale.
7. **John Paul Jones.** In the 1779 battle between his Bonhomme Richard and HMS Serapis, Jones —
by tradition — answered the call to surrender with "I have not yet begun to fight," and WON.
8. **Benedict Arnold.** Once a hero of Saratoga, Arnold plotted in 1780 to surrender West Point to
the British; the plot failed and his name became a byword for traitor.
9. **Nathan Hale.** The 21-year-old Connecticut schoolteacher was hanged as a spy
by the British on
September 22, 1776; his famous last words are traditionally attributed to him.
10. **TRUE.** Deborah Sampson enlisted in 1782 disguised as "Robert Shurtliff,"
served about 17 months,
was wounded in action, and later received a military pension for her service.

Round 9 — Monuments, Mottoes & American Icons

1. **France.** The Statue of Liberty was a gift from the people of France, dedicated
October 28, 1886 —
sculpted by Bartholdi, with an iron framework engineered by Gustave Eiffel.
2. **South Dakota.** Mount Rushmore rises from the Black Hills near Keystone,
South Dakota.

3. **Patrick Henry.** He delivered the "Give me liberty, or give me death!" speech at a Virginia convention in Richmond on March 23, 1775. (Retell-it: no transcript survives — the wording we know was reconstructed decades later by his biographer, working from witnesses' memories.)
4. **The Washington Monument.** At about 555 feet, it was the tallest structure in the world when completed in 1884 — until the Eiffel Tower passed it in 1889. It's still the world's tallest stone obelisk.
5. **1892.** Francis Bellamy wrote the Pledge for the 400th anniversary of Columbus's voyage; the words "under God" were added by Congress in 1954.
6. **13 arrows.** One for each original colony — balanced by the olive branch of peace. (The eagle faces the olive branch.)
7. **The War of 1812.** British troops burned the White House and the Capitol on August 24, 1814.

(Retell-it: First Lady Dolley Madison helped save the famous full-length portrait of George Washington before fleeing.)
8. **"God Bless America."** Irving Berlin wrote it in 1918 and revised it in 1938, when Kate Smith's Armistice Day radio broadcast made it an unofficial national hymn.
9. **Both are UNESCO World Heritage Sites.** Independence Hall was inscribed in 1979 and the Statue of Liberty in 1984 — two of the very few U.S. cultural sites on the world list.
10. **LEGEND.** Franklin never formally proposed the turkey. In a private 1784 letter to his daughter

he mocked the bald eagle as a bird "of bad moral character" and praised the turkey as "a much more respectable bird" — but it was satire, and his own design for the Great Seal had no bird at all.

SCORING SHEET (print one per player or per team)

Round	Player/Team score (out of 10)
1 — The Road to 1776	_____
2 — The Declaration & the Signers	_____
3 — Old Glory & Our Symbols	_____
4 — Presidents & Founders	_____
5 — The 50 States	_____
6 — America 250	_____
7 — The Fourth of July Itself	_____
8 — The Fight for Freedom	_____
9 — Monuments, Mottoes & Icons	_____
TOTAL (out of 100)	_____

85-100: Founding Father/Mother · **60-84:** True Patriot · **35-59:** Proud American ·
Under 35: Welcome to the party — you learned something today!